

A close-up photograph of a Verreaux's sifaka lemur clinging to a tree trunk. The lemur's body is pressed against the bark, with its long tail visible on the right side. The background is a soft-focus forest scene with green foliage and a warm, golden light filtering through the trees.

Leaping lemur

Kicking with its hind legs, a Verreaux's sifaka leaps through the dry forest of southern Madagascar. This agile lemur spends most of its life in trees, keeping its body upright by clinging to the trunks. It stays upright even when it jumps. Adults are powerful jumpers and can clear up to 33 ft (10 m) in a single bound from one tree to the next. On the ground, sifakas move like someone jumping along a tightrope, with their bodies standing straight and their arms held out for balance, while they hop along sideways.